Discharge and Transfer of Care Policy

Reference	ADM-DIS-04 v3
Owner	Director of Patient Flow
Approved by	Quality and Patient Safety Committee
Effective date	06/07/2026
Next review	06/07/2029
Applies to	All clinical areas of the Centre Hospitalier Saint-Aubin

1. Discharge summary

A discharge summary is sent to the general practitioner (GP) on the day of discharge. It lists the medicines (new, changed, stopped), the follow-up arrangements and the investigations still pending.

2. Pending results

The consultant who discharged the patient remains responsible for results pending at discharge. **Every abnormal result finalised after discharge is communicated to the GP within 2 working days of the date the result is finalised.** Working days are Monday to Friday. Normal results are filed without communication.

3. Follow-up

Follow-up appointments requested on the discharge summary are booked before discharge or, if clinic capacity does not allow, within 5 working days; a booking later than the requested timeframe is escalated to the clinic manager.

4. Governance, audit and training

This document is controlled. Printed copies are uncontrolled: the current version is held on the hospital document management system and a printed copy must be checked against it before use.

The document owner reviews the content at least every three years or earlier when national guidance, a serious incident or an audit finding requires it. Interim changes are approved by the relevant committee chair and recorded in the revision history.

Compliance is audited by the clinical audit department on a rolling sample of records. Results are reported to the quality and patient safety committee, which agrees actions with the ward managers and monitors their completion.

Staff who identify a deviation from this document, or a situation it does not cover, should discuss it with the senior clinician on duty and report it through the incident reporting system. Reporting is a learning tool and not a disciplinary process.

5. Revision history

Version	Date	Author	Summary of change
1.0	06/07/2021	Director of Patient Flow	First issue
2.0	06/07/2023	Director of Patient Flow	Triennial review; format harmonised
3.0	06/06/2025	Director of Patient Flow	Tables updated after clinical audit
current	06/07/2026	Director of Patient Flow	Review and re-issue

Annex A. Implementation notes

Data protection: any patient information handled under this document is processed in accordance with the data protection policy of the hospital. Access to records is limited to staff involved in the care of the patient.

Training on this document is part of the induction programme for clinical staff and is refreshed through the annual mandatory training cycle. Agency and locum staff receive a short briefing at the start of their first shift.

Where this document refers to a role (for example the ward pharmacist or the senior nurse), the post-holder on duty carries out the task or delegates it to a suitably trained colleague who remains accountable to them.

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Equality and diversity: this document has been assessed for its effect on patients and staff with protected characteristics. Reasonable adjustments, interpreters and accessible formats are available through the patient experience team.

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Annex B. Implementation notes

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